

Beat That!

Digit Caption
'Once More!!'

Last Month's Winner!

Mangesh Patki
Aundh, Pune
"Double-Click!"



E-mail your caption with the subject 'Beat That', and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win **Unix for Programmers and Users** by Graham Glass and King Ables. Published by Pearson Education, Delhi



Photograph Jiten Gandhi

Every month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 15th of this month.

The movies on offer aren't the latest, though: the most recent of the 10 currently available available is *Short Circuit*, a 1986 flick. Why? MSpot CEO Daren Tsui said film rights are notoriously difficult to procure, and since Sprint's movie service is a first-of-its-kind, it has to be content with old movies in order to get it off the ground.

MSpot, however, now has deals negotiated for the rights to 380 films, and as the service gains attention and subscribers, Tsui

expects the movie studios will have more interest in putting newer content on the network.

That, of course, depends on how well the service does. A little after news of Sprint's movie service appeared, ZDNet released a list of seven reasons why movies on the cell phone won't work: first, that many films have wide vistas, fast action, split screens and multiple colours, which do not work well on a small viewer. Second, the obvious point of how long one can be expected to

squint at a little screen. Then there's the issue of whether the shifting between movies and calls will be seamless, and of battery life. Imagine watching part of a movie, then recharging your handset and picking up where you left off! ZDNet also talks about the noise factor—imagine a scream from a horror

movie emanating from your cell phone's speakers in a public place!

"This is a controversial service," Tsui said. "Some people don't believe in it because of the small screen size, but look at the market. Services like MobiTV, Sprint TV and Verizon Wireless' Vcast have been doing great. There is a consumer appetite for video on the mobile phone. You can't dispute that."

HE'S GOT A JOB

Asimo As Receptionist

Honda recently announced that its Asimo, the world's first walking humanoid robot, is set to make its office debut in 2006 as a receptionist. The latest version Asimo



will be starting its new job in April at a Honda office in Wako, north of Tokyo. The prototype can guide guests to a room, push a cart with a load of up to 10 kilograms, and serve coffee on a tray!

"The level of Asimo's capability was just good enough to entertain people on the stage in the past, but the new Asimo can work at places closer to us," says Satoshi Shigemitsu, the Honda official in charge of the robot's development. "Honda is aiming to create a humanoid robot that can help people and live together with people."

During its unveiling, the new Asimo, which stands more than four feet tall and weighs 54 kg, ran at top speed on a stage, and then carried four cups on a tray to a coffee table. Honda plans to produce more models and lease them to organisations for an estimated rental fee of

¥20 million (Rs 75 lakh) per year.

Asimo, of course, isn't the

